

**WARRANT
SPRING ANNUAL TOWN MEETING
APRIL 22, 2025**

THE COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS

Middlesex, ss

To Any Constable of the Town of Natick in said County:
Greeting:

In the name of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts you are required to notify the qualified Town Meeting Members of the said Town of Natick to meet on **Tuesday, April 22, 2025, at 7:30 PM**, Kennedy Middle School, Natick, MA, then and there to act on the following Articles:

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| Article 1 | Authorize Select Board to Acquire, Obtain, Abandon or Relocate Easements |
| Article 2 | Committee Article |
| Article 3 | Omnibus Budget |
| Article 4 | Rescind Authorized, Unissued Debt |
| Article 5 | Unpaid Bills |
| Article 6 | Revolving Funds |
| Article 7 | Stabilization Funds and OPEB |
| Article 8 | Transfer of Unexpended Bond Proceeds |
| Article 9 | PEG Access and Cable Related Fund |
| Article 10 | School Bus Transportation Subsidy |
| Article 11 | Capital Equipment and Improvement |
| Article 12 | Collective Bargaining |
| Article 13 | Personnel Board Classification and Pay Plan |
| Article 14 | Increase Amount to be Credited Under Senior/Veteran's Work Program, Ch.59, S. 5K and 5N |
| Article 15 | Community Preservation Act (CPA) Administrative Funds |
| Article 16 | Amend Zoning Bylaws: Section 326.1 Height |
| Article 17 | Amend Zoning Bylaws: Floodplain District Bylaw |
| Article 18 | Amend Zoning Bylaws: Accessory Dwelling (ADU), Gross Floor Area |
| Article 19 | Amend Zoning Bylaws and Zoning Map: Indoor Recreational Overlay District |
| Article 20 | Amend Zoning Bylaws: Body Art Establishment |
| Article 21 | Amend Zoning Bylaws: Use Regulation Schedule |
| Article 22 | Amend Town of Natick Bylaws, Article 80: Water Supply Protection |
| Article 23 | Charter and Bylaw Review Committee Report and Extension |
| Article 24 | Bylaw Changes |
| Article 25 | Stabilization Funds |

Article 1
Authorize Select Board to Acquire, Obtain, Abandon or Relocate Easements
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board, during Fiscal Year 2026, to acquire on behalf of the Town any and all easements for any of the following purposes: roads, sidewalks, vehicular and/or pedestrian access or passage, drainage and utilities, provided however that such authorization pertains only to easements acquired at no cost to the Town; and, further, to authorize the Select Board, subsequent to a public hearing, during Fiscal Year 2026 to abandon or relocate easements acquired for any of the foregoing purposes; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 2
Committee Article
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to hear and discuss the reports of town officers, boards, and committees; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 3
Omnibus Budget
(Town Administrator)

Town

To determine what sum of money the Town will appropriate and raise, transfer from available funds for the operation of the government of the Town of Natick, including debt and interest, during Fiscal Year 2025 (July 1, 2024, through June 30, 2025) and to provide for reserve funds for Fiscal Year 2025 and to see what budgets for Fiscal Year 2025 will be reduced to offset said additional appropriations;

To determine what sum of money the Town will appropriate and raise, or transfer from available funds for the operation of the government of the Town of Natick, including debt and interest, during Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025, through June 30, 2026) and to provide for reserve funds for Fiscal Year 2026;

Libraries

To determine what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, or otherwise provide, for the maintenance and operation of the Morse Institute Library and the Bacon Free Library, for Fiscal Year 2025 (July 1, 2024, through June 30, 2025);

To determine what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, or otherwise provide, for the maintenance and operation of the Morse Institute Library and the Bacon Free Library, for Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025, through June 30, 2026); or otherwise act thereon.

Article 4
Rescind Authorized, Unissued Debt
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to rescind the authorization for unissued debt that has been determined is no longer needed for the completion of various projects; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 5
Unpaid Bills
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide for the payment of unpaid bills of previous years, incurred by the departments, boards and officers of the Town of Natick; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 6
Revolving Funds
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote on the limit on the total amount that may be expended from each revolving fund established pursuant to Chapter 44 section 53E ½ of the General Laws and Town by-law; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 7
Stabilization Funds and OPEB
(Town Administrator)

General Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Stabilization Fund established under Article 22 of the warrant for Annual Town Meeting of 1961, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

Operational Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Operational Stabilization Fund established by vote of the 2011 Spring Annual Town Meeting under Article 4, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

Capital Stabilization

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for the purpose of supplementing the Capital Stabilization Fund established by vote of the 2010 Fall Annual Town Meeting under Article 2, as authorized by Chapter 40, Section 5B of the General Laws, as amended;

OPEB

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide for, the Other Post-Employment Benefits Liability Trust Fund established by vote of the 2017 Spring Annual Town Meeting under Article 15, pursuant to the provisions of Chapter 32B, Section 20 of the General Laws as amended by section 15 of Chapter 218 of the Acts of 2016; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 8
Transfer of Unexpended Bond Proceeds
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will authorize the transfer of unexpended proceeds from amounts previously borrowed to pay costs of various capital projects, which projects are now complete, and for

which such funds are no longer needed, to pay costs of one or more capital projects; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 9
PEG Access and Cable Related Fund
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to appropriate from the PEG Access and Cable Related Fund, established by vote of 2019 Special Town Meeting #1 under Article 1, as authorized by Chapter 44, Section 53F ³/₄ of the General Laws, as amended, to fund PEG access programming, as well as certain other municipal cable related expenses; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 10
School Bus Transportation Subsidy
(Superintendent of Schools)

To see if the Town will vote to appropriate and raise, or transfer from available funds, a sum of money for the purpose of operation and administration of the school bus transportation system, and to reduce or offset fees charged for students who elect to use the school bus transportation system for transportation to and from school, for Fiscal Year 2026 (July 1, 2025 through June 30, 2026); or otherwise act thereon.

Article 11
Capital Equipment and Improvement
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, borrow, transfer from available funds or otherwise provide to implement a Capital Improvement Program as may be required for capital equipment for the various departments of the Town of Natick; to protect the physical infrastructure of the Town of Natick, to add new physical infrastructure, or to improve community assets; and further to determine whether this appropriation shall be raised by borrowing or otherwise; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 12
Collective Bargaining
(Town Administrator)

To see what sum of money the Town will vote to raise and appropriate, transfer from available funds, or otherwise provide, to implement any Collective Bargaining Agreements between the Town of Natick and any recognized bargaining units of the Town; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 13
Personnel Board Classification and Pay Plan
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town, pursuant to the authority contained in Section 108A of Chapter 41 of the General Laws, will vote to amend Article 24 of the Natick Town By-Laws, specifically the Classification and Pay Plan referenced in Section 3, paragraph 3.10 therein, by adding, deleting or amending position titles; re-classifying positions to a different Grade; and/or effecting changes in the salary ranges as presently established; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 14
Increase Amount to be Credited Under Senior/Veteran's Work Program, Ch.59, 5K
(Board of Assessors/Council on Aging)

To see if the Town will vote to adjust the PROPERTY TAX LIABILITY REDUCED IN EXCHANGE FOR VOLUNTEER SERVICES; PERSONS OVER AGE 60 Ch 59 § 5K and REDUCTION OF PROPERTY TAX OBLIGATION OF VETERAN IN EXCHANGE FOR VOLUNTEER SERVICES, Ch 59 § 5N by allowing the maximum reduction of the real property tax bill to be based on 125 volunteer service hours in a given tax year, rather than \$1,500; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 15
Community Preservation Act (CPA) Administrative Funds
(Community Preservation Committee)

To see if the Town will vote to appropriate the five (5) percent Administrative Funds from the Community Preservation Fund for use by the Community Preservation Committee (CPC) for administrative expenses in the Fiscal Year 2026, in accordance with M.G.L. Chapter 44B, Section 6, or otherwise act thereon.

Article 16
Amend Zoning Bylaw: Section 326.1 Height
(Planning Board)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending Section 326.1 Height; and further amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning Bylaws, where applicable; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 17
Amend Zoning Bylaws: Flood Plain District
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending § III-A.3 Flood Plain District; amend Section 200 – Definitions; and further amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning Bylaws, where applicable; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 18
Amend Zoning Bylaws: Accessory Dwelling (ADU), Gross Floor Area
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending Section 200 – Definitions, Gross Floor Area and Accessory Dwelling Units Gross Floor Area; amending § III-M Accessory Dwelling Unit regarding Gross Floor Area; and further amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning Bylaws, where applicable; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 19
Amend Zoning Bylaws and Zoning Map: Indoor Recreational Overlay District
(Planning Board)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending Section III-L Indoor Recreational Overlay District, and amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning

Bylaws, where applicable; and further amend the Natick Zoning Map by deleting the Indoor Recreational Overlay District; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 20
Amend Zoning Bylaws: Body Art Establishment
(Planning Board)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending Section III-A.2.F9. Body Art Establishment; amend Section 200 – Definitions for Body Art and Personal Services Establishment; and further amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning Bylaws, where applicable; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 21
Amend Zoning Bylaws: Use Regulation Schedule
(Planning Board)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick Zoning Bylaws by amending § III-A.2 Use Regulations Schedule (Use Categories within the Use Headers: I. Professional and Medical Office Uses; J. Research and Development, Laboratory, and Technology Uses; K. Manufacturing and Industrial Uses; M. Other Uses); amend Section 200 – Definitions; and further amend any other associated sections of the Natick Zoning Bylaws, where applicable; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 22
Amend Town of Natick Bylaws, Article 80: Water Supply Protection
(Town Administrator)

To see if the Town will vote to amend the Natick General Bylaws by amending Article 80, Water Supply Protection, to update the provisions relating to nonessential outdoor water use restrictions; or otherwise act thereon.

Article 23
Charter and Bylaw Review Committee Report and Extension
(Charter and ByLaw Review Committee)

To see what action the Town will take to hear a report of the Charter and ByLaw Review Committee,

To see what action the Town Meeting will take to extend or to revise the term of the Charter and ByLaw Review Committee,

To see what action the Town Meeting will take to appropriate funds to continue work with special legal counsel and to authorize, if necessary, the Charter and ByLaw Review Committee to use such counsel; Or otherwise act thereon.

Article 24
Bylaw Changes
(Charter and Bylaw Review Committee)

To see what actions the town will take to amend the Bylaws of the Town with regard to:

Article 21A Collector of Taxes:

- 1) Article 21 – A Collector of Taxes i) in Section 6 to modify or add appropriate references to the General Laws for interest rates on delinquent charges and bills in tax title and ii) in Section 7 to modify a) the timing and publication requirements including but not limited to changing the word “newspaper of general circulation” to the Town website and /or to print publication of general circulation or other term(s) and b) the references to payments plans to refer to payment plans not in default or further arrears, to include amounts in tax title, and to exclude senior tax deferrals not due for payment and c) to include amounts due by year and iii) to add descriptive titles to Sections 1 through 7 inclusive;

Article 41 Contracts, Town Property and Regulations of Town Board and Officials:

i) add references in Section 1, and Section 3 to add all boards, officials, commissions, committees and instrumentalities of the Town to the existing reference to departments in Section 1 and in addition to “board” and official” in Section 3 and ii) add language in Sections 1, 2 and 3 respectively to the effect (either in the following specific wording or similar wording) that *“Nothing herein, however, shall affect the ability of the Chief Procurement Officer to exercise the duties of said office as defined by Mass. Gen. Law Chapter 30B”* and *“Said actions shall be in addition to all responsibilities conferred to the Chief Procurement Officer pursuant to Massachusetts General Laws”* and *“Nothing herein shall be construed as precluding the use of electronic records maintenance and retention, so long as such means and methods are permissible under otherwise applicable law”*; iii) change references to the Board of Selectmen to Select Board; iv) to change all gender references to non gender references; v) change “designated procurement officer to include or be replaced by “ Chief Procurement Officer”; vi) add the word “rule” after the word “local law” in Section 3; vii) add the word “residual” and delete the word “replacement” before the word “value” in Section 5; viii) to allow a shorter or longer period than 14 days if required or allowed by statute in Section 6 and to insert the word “a” before sale in Section 6; ix) add the Town Administrator or Town Manager as the case may be to the exemption language in Section 2; x) add language at the end of section 6 stating “ *For more precise requirements on such sales, see Mass. Gen. Laws, Chapter 60, Sections 37-84A or successor legislation, or as said laws may hereinafter be amended*” or words to similar effect; xi) modify or delete the last sentence in section 9.

Article 81 Chemical Storage Tanks and Systems of the ByLaws:

To see what action the town will take regarding Article 11 Town Clerk of the ByLaws:

- 2) i) add “propane” in Section 2a Applicability and add exceptions for “propane” in Sections 6(e), 9(c), 10(a) or other sections;

Article 22 Town Counsel and New ByLaw Section

- 3) “i) Add a new Article to the ByLaws consistent with Article 2 Section 11 (e) of the charter and any other relevant provision of the charter or general laws i) to establish a standing committee for and or of town meeting to study review and report on zoning bylaw changes in advance of town meeting action and to determine the composition, method of appointment, term, powers and duties of such committee and/or ii) amend Article 22 of the ByLaws to require and to provide for the appointment of legal counsel with specialized knowledge in zoning and land use matters, to provide for the method of appointment, qualifications, powers and duties of such counsel including but not limited to advising the representative town meeting, advisory committees of town meeting, the planning board and/or town moderator; Or Otherwise Act Thereon

Article 25
Stabilization Funds
(Paul Griesmer, Rick Jennett et. al.)

To see what actions the Town will take i) to change the purpose of any stabilization fund of the town, including without limitation the Operational Stabilization Fund created under Article 4 of 2011 Spring Annual Town Meeting and the Capital Stabilization Fund created under Article 2 of 2010 Fall Annual Town Meeting, to allow such stabilization funds to be used for any lawful municipal purpose whether any such lawful municipal purpose becomes the sole purpose or an additional purpose of any stabilization fund so changed and/or ii) to appropriate funds from any stabilization fund with an eligible purpose to support the FY 2026 budget, and/or iii) to appropriate funds from any stabilization fund into an existing stabilization fund from which such appropriations can be made to support the FY 2026 budget and then to appropriate therefrom funds in support of the FY 2026 budget provided that the scope of this warrant article shall not include or be applied to the I&I Stabilization Fund, the OPEB stabilization or trust fund or the FAR Bonus Stabilization Fund;

And

To see what actions the town will take a) to adopt any of the revenue raising provisions of the so called Municipal Empowerment Act (the "MEA") or similar legislation as may become law prior to the dissolution of 2025 Spring Annual Town Meeting including without limitation adopting local option increases in meals tax or hotel tax or enacting permissible local option motor vehicle excise tax and b) to appropriate such revenues to support the FY 2026 budget; Or Otherwise Act Thereon.

You are directed to serve this Warrant by causing an attested copy of said Warrant to be posted in the Post Office in said Natick, and at the following public places in said Natick, to wit: Precinct 1: Reliable Cleaners, 214 West Central Street; Precinct 2: Cole Recreation Center, 179 Boden Lane; Precinct 3: Kennedy Middle School, Mill Street; Precinct 4: 2 Summer St.; Precinct 5: Wilson Middle School, Rutledge Road; Precinct 6: East Natick Fire Station, Rhode Island Avenue; Precinct 7: Lilja Elementary School, Bacon Street; Precinct 8: Natick High School, 15 West Street; Precinct 9: Community Senior Center, 117 East Central Street; and Precinct 10: Memorial Elementary School, 107 Eliot Street.

Above locations being at least one public place in each Precinct, in the Town of Natick, and also posted in the Natick U.S. Post Office, Town Hall, Bacon Free Library and Morse Institute Library seven days at least before April 22, 2025; also by causing the titles of the articles on the Warrant for the 2025 Spring Annual Town Meeting to be published once in "*The Metrowest Daily News*" with notice of availability of an attested copy of said Warrant, said Newspaper published in the Town of Natick and said publication to be February 28, 2025.

Hereof fail not and make due return of this Warrant with your doings thereon to the Town Clerk at or before the time appointed for holding said meeting.

Given under our hands this 24th day of February, 2025.

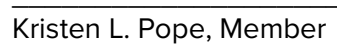
Select Board for the Town of Natick


Kathryn M. Coughlin, Chair


Bruce T. Evans, Vice Chair


Richard Sidney, Clerk


Linda Wollschlager, Member


Kristen L. Pope, Member

Certified copies of the Warrant are available at the Office of the Town Clerk, Natick Town Hall, 13 East Central St., Natick, MA between the hours of 8:00 a.m. - 5:00 p.m., Monday through Wednesday; 8:00 a.m.- 7:00 p.m. on Thursday; and 8:00 a.m.-12:30 p.m. on Friday. The Warrant may also be accessed from the Town website www.natickma.gov.